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04.12.2024

Blockchain & Web3 Observatory

The Web3 playbook: New rules of the game for businesses

Workshop Web3

Welcome and introduction

Giacomo Vella, *Blockchain & Web3 Observatory*

How business partnerships work in web3

Giacomo Vella e Davide Ghezzi, *Blockchain & Web3 Observatory*

Case study: Superfluid Finance

Michele D'Aliessi, *Superfluid*

Case study: LFJ

Davide Fi, *LFJ*

The role of user community

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Case study: Over the Reality

Diego Di Tommaso, *Over the Reality*

Case study: Folks Finance

Filippo Moraschi, *Folks Finance*

Innovative dynamics in market competition

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Q&A and open discussion

moderated by Valeria Portale, Blockchain & Web3 Observatory

Conclusion and aperitif

Valeria Portale, *Blockchain & Web3 Observatory*



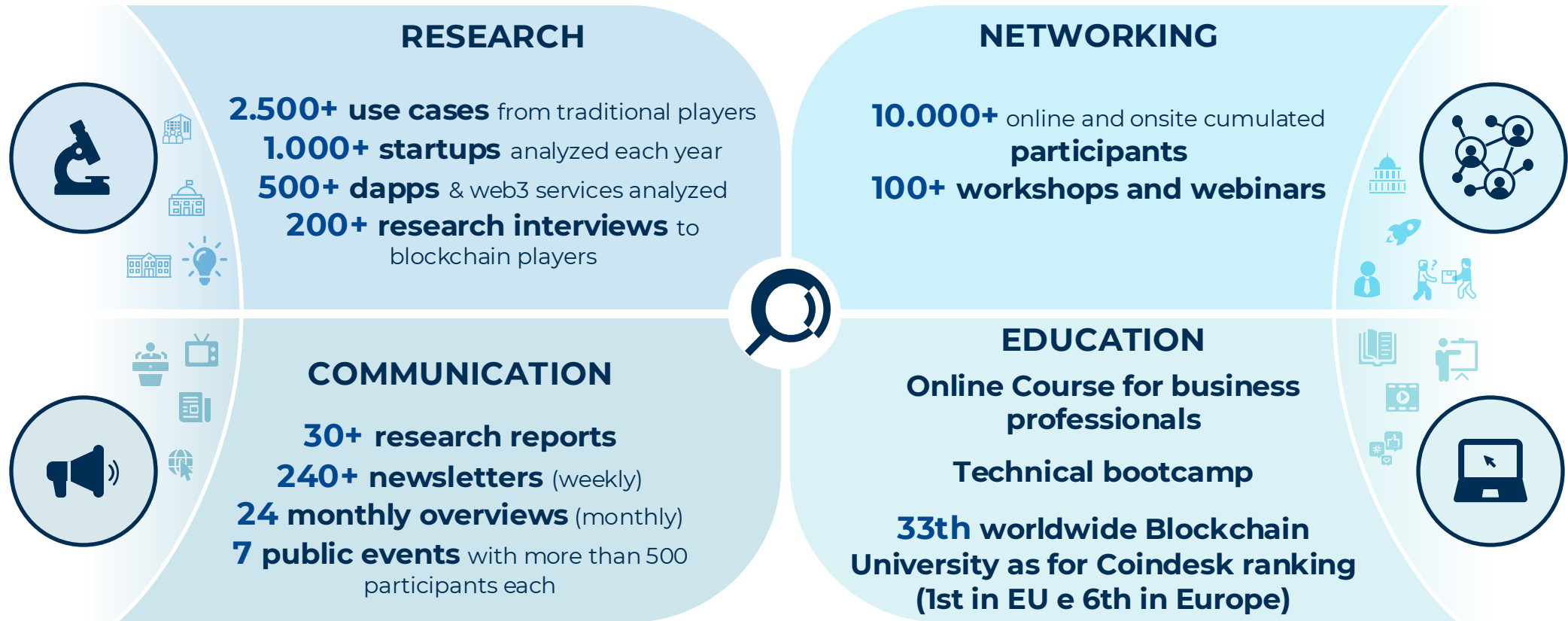
Giacomo Vella

👤 Director

🔗 Blockchain & Web3 Observatory



The **Blockchain & Web3 Observatory's** mission is to **generate and share knowledge** on Blockchain and web3 topics. The Observatory **contributes actively to the development of the Italian and international market**, generating contents and events for all the players of the industry.



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The Advisory Board plays a key role in supporting research by providing **advice and strategic guidance**.

It also helps to define research **priorities** and identify relevant areas of interest.

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Blockchain for business



Ecosistemi
Blockchain



Tracciabilità e
supply chain



Crypto assets
e token

Mercato italiano



Adozione
dei cittadini



Adozione delle
aziende



Analisi
dell'offerta



Startup
italiane

Decentralized web



SSI e Digital
Identity



DApp e DeFi



Token e
NFT



Metaverso
decentralizzato



Governance e
DAO

Filoni Tech



DAO e DAPP
Governance



Identificazione e
privacy



Layer 2 e
soluzioni
di scalabilità



Interoperabilità



Token



Wallet e interazione
on chain

Legal



MiCar



Pilot regime



Copyright



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**Giacomo
Vella**

👤 Director

👤 Blockchain & Web3 Observatory



**Davide
Ghezzi**

👤 Researcher

👤 Blockchain & Web3 Observatory



- **Web3 as a new playground**
 - How business partnerships work in Web3
 - The role of user community
 - Innovative dynamics in market competition



Web3 enables a seamless user experience across different services, due to the possibility of **certifying digital identity** and easily **proving the ownership** of digital assets and attributes



Web1

Read



Web2

Read
Write



Web3

Read
Write
Own

Why a research on Web3 for business?



Web3

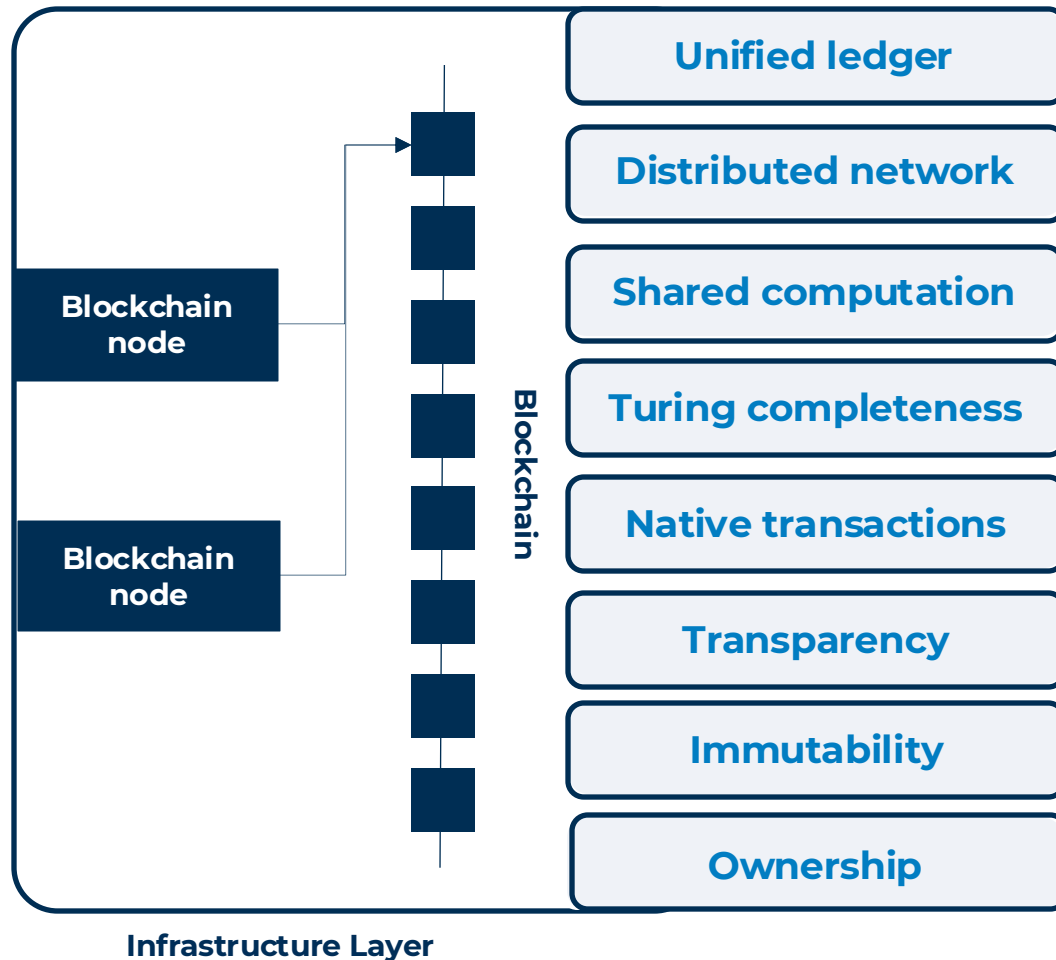
Read
Write
Own



Aren't we **overfocused** on
technological aspects?



Where we were at?



Lego-like service integration



Enhanced «copy & paste»



Identity, data & asset ownership



Increased user involvement



Tokenization



Web3 is changing the rules of business



Lego-like service integration



Enhanced «copy & paste»



Identity, data & asset ownership



Increased user involvement



Tokenization



Theoretical perspective:

**Relationships among
players in the business
ecosystem**



Web3

Read
Write
Own

We **need** to investigate **real projects** to understand how
Web3 can change the rules in business

Empirical observation

250+

Web3 projects
by **incumbent players**

100+

Cases and initiatives
by **Web3-native players**

10+

Academic papers
about Web3



Web3 is changing the rules of business



Lego-like service integration



Enhanced «copy & paste»



Identity, data & asset ownership



Increased user involvement



Tokenization



New relationship with
business partners



New relationship with
users



New relationship with
competitors



Web3

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Lego-like service integration



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Identity, data & asset ownership



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Tokenization



**New relationship with
business partners**



**New relationship with
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**New relationship with
competitors**



Web3

Read
Write
Own



Société Générale and MakerDAO

Year: 2023

Platform:  ethereum



Société Générale is a leading European financial services group, offering banking and investment solutions worldwide. Its subsidiary, **SG Forge**, specializes in blockchain and digital asset innovation.



Maker is a decentralized finance (DeFi) protocol on Ethereum, known for its **DAI stablecoin**, that enables users to mint a stablecoin against collateral without intermediaries.

SocGen explored a novel form of collaboration with a DAO, to gain access to liquidity by **securing a decentralized loan** through a **DeFi DApp, reducing costs and intermediaries**.



Société Générale and MakerDAO

Year: 2023

Platform:  ethereum



In 2020, Société Générale issued €40 million of covered bonds as security tokens **«OFH tokens»** on Ethereum

In 2023, Société Générale applies for \$20M **MakerDAO loan** using **OFH token as collateral** as part of a pilot project.

The Maker community discussed and the DAO approved a **DAI stablecoins credit line to SG-FORGE**

MakerDAO added SG-Forge to its vaults with a credit limit of \$30 million in DAI. The vault is backed by 40 million euros in tokenized bonds, making the loans overcollateralized

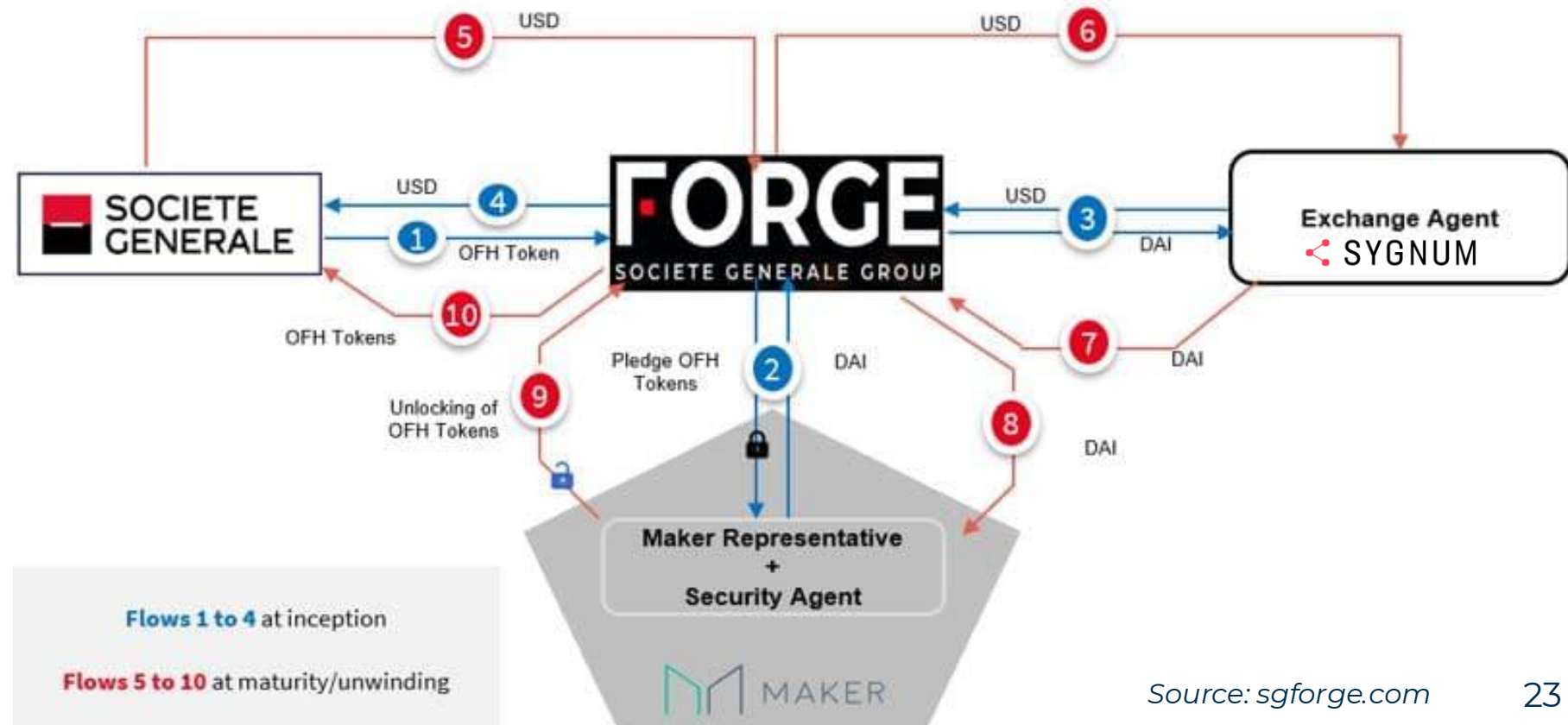


Société Générale and MakerDAO

Year: 2023

Platform: ethereum

SG-Forge used its MakerDAO vault to **withdraw \$7 million worth of MakerDAO's stablecoin DAI**





Société Générale and MakerDAO

Year: 2023

Platform:  ethereum

SocGen redefined traditional partnership models by
securing a **decentralized loan through a DeFi DApp**,
reducing costs and reliance on intermediaries

- The **technical integration** of the Maker protocol with SocGen's systems was reportedly **fast and smooth**
- **Maker** protocol gained **interests** and increased **legitimacy**



- **KYC, due diligence and jurisdiction** were **necessary**, and the SocGen team had to find solutions
- **The DAO had to approve** the relationship with a traditional player

ticketmaster

Ticketmaster and Avenged Sevenfold



Avenged Sevenfold is a popular American heavy metal band known for their passionate fanbase. The band launched an **NFT project**, offering exclusive perks and experiences to their community.

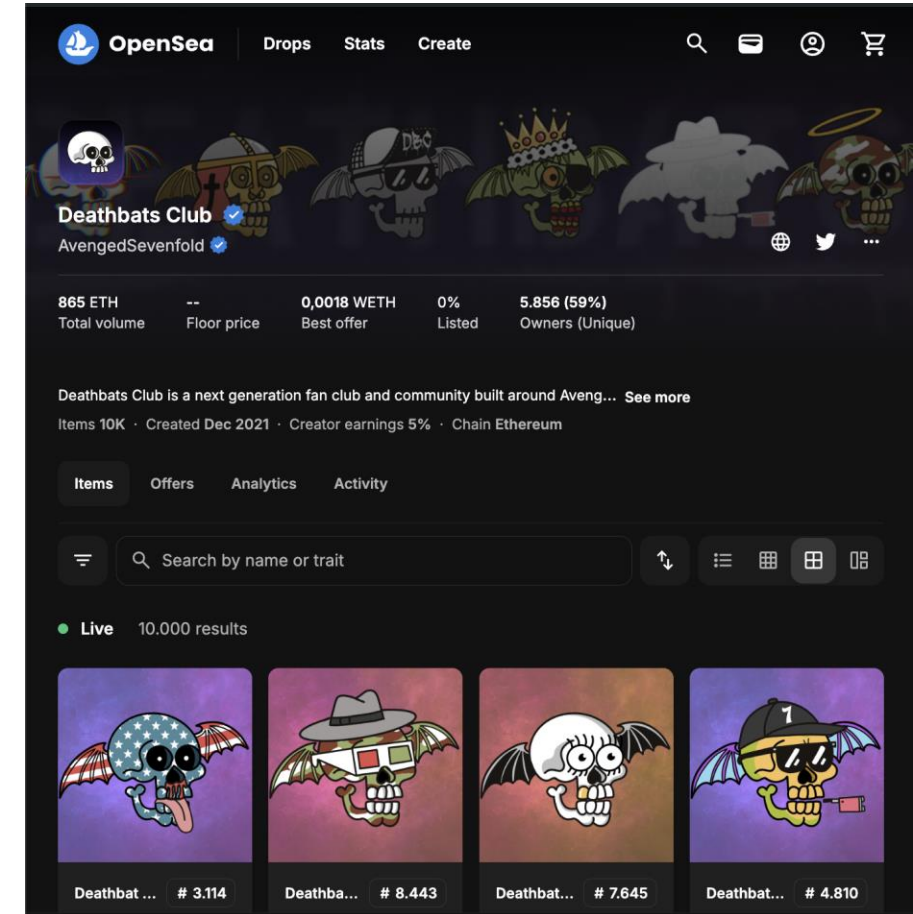
ticketmaster

Ticketmaster is a leading global ticketing platform that provides services for purchasing, selling, and managing event tickets.

Ticketmaster partnered with Avenged Sevenfold to test its **NFT token-gating feature**, allowing *Deathbats Club* NFT holders to access exclusive perks like priority ticketing ahead of the full feature rollout

Launched in: 2023

Platform:  **ethereum**



ticketmaster

Ticketmaster and Avenged Sevenfold

Launched in: 2023

Platform:  **ethereum**

ticketmaster



In 2021, the heavy metal band Avenged Sevenfold explored the potential of NFT communities to engage and benefit their fans

The band first tested the market with a pilot NFT collection and received **5,000 wallet** addresses in response

Later that year, Avenged Sevenfold launched «**The Deathbats Club**», a collection of **10,000 Ethereum-based NFTs** with varying levels of rarity, each offering **exclusive perks** (merchandise, meet-and-greets, and more)

The band decided to **retain full creative and technical control** of the NFT project **without signing external contracts**

ticketmaster

Ticketmaster and Avenged Sevenfold

Launched in: 2023

Platform:  `ethereum`

ticketmaster



After formalizing a partnership with the band, **Ticketmaster announced** an **NFT token-gating feature for artists**. The band tested the token-gating feature ahead of the full rollout.

Owners of the 10,000 Deathbats Club NFTs were offered early access to tickets for two shows. Around **1,000 tickets** were **purchased using the NFT-gating feature**.

"It's a normal process [...] except without the 1,000-person queue and without the scalpers and the bots getting in there and taking all the tickets right away"

Matt Sanders, Avenged Sevenfold's singer

ticketmaster

Ticketmaster and Avenged Sevenfold

Launched in: 2023

Platform:  `ethereum`

Ticketmaster introduced **a new type of collaboration** centered on the band's NFT project. In theory, **this could have happened even without signing a formal business partnership!**

- Ticketmaster **leveraged existing tokens** and easily **tapped into an existing community**
- The band found a way to **engage and deeply connect with** a portion of their **fanbase**



- **Risks** related to the **speculative nature of NFTs**
- **Risk** of the band losing **control over the NFT project** due to openness





What about **native players**
in Web3?

Which **business strategies** are
they implementing?



Argent is a self-custodial wallet that **simplifies DeFi** by **integrating and streamlining interactions** with multiple DeFi protocols, **without requiring formal partnerships**.

Services offered:



DeFi lending and borrowing



In-wallet liquidity provisioning and swaps



Savings and yield generation



Yearn Finance is a DeFi aggregator that **connects with various DeFi protocols** to **automatically allocate users' funds** where they can earn **the highest yield**

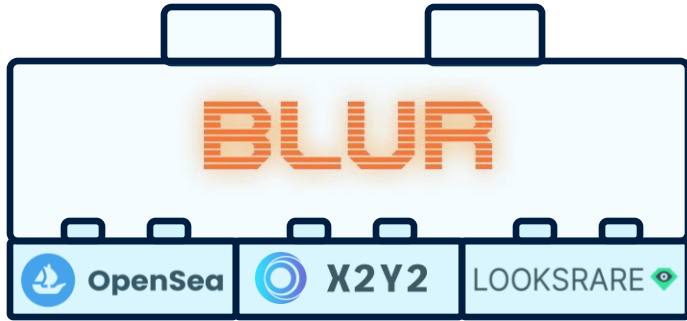
Services offered:



*Integration with multiple
DeFi Protocols*



*Improved
user experience*



Blur is an **NFT marketplace** that **connects with and aggregates listings** from major platforms, offering users a **seamless interface** to view, buy, and sell NFTs

Services offered:



Aggregated listings from multiple marketplaces



Gas fees optimization



What could they do to go full Web3?



SOCIETE
GENERALE



MAKER

ticketmaster



Leverage Web3's **openness**:

Integrate their tokens into other DeFi DApps to offer **additional services** to enlarge the value creation of the ecosystem

What if users could directly take a loan from AAVE using OFH tokens as collateral?

Leverage Web3's **composability**:

Stimulate external actors to **build upon** their existing **tokens**, providing incentives, technical guidance, etc.

What if other brands leverage Avenged Sevenfold NFTs to develop tailored services?



Web3 is changing the rules of business



New relationship with business partners

In **Web2**, **formal partnerships** and contractual integrations often govern how companies collaborate.

In **Web3**, the permissionless nature of blockchain protocols makes **partnerships less formal and more fluid**.

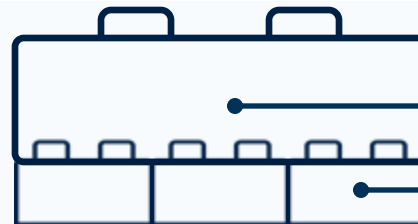


New relationship with users



New relationship with competitors

Strategy 1:
**Permissionless
business partnership**



You can *leverage existing Lego blocks*

Or you can *be a Lego block*

- Web3 as a new playground
- How business partnerships work in Web3
- **The role of user community**
- Innovative dynamics in market competition





Web3 is changing the rules of business



New relationship with
business partners



New relationship with
users



New relationship with
competitors



Web3

Read
Write
Own



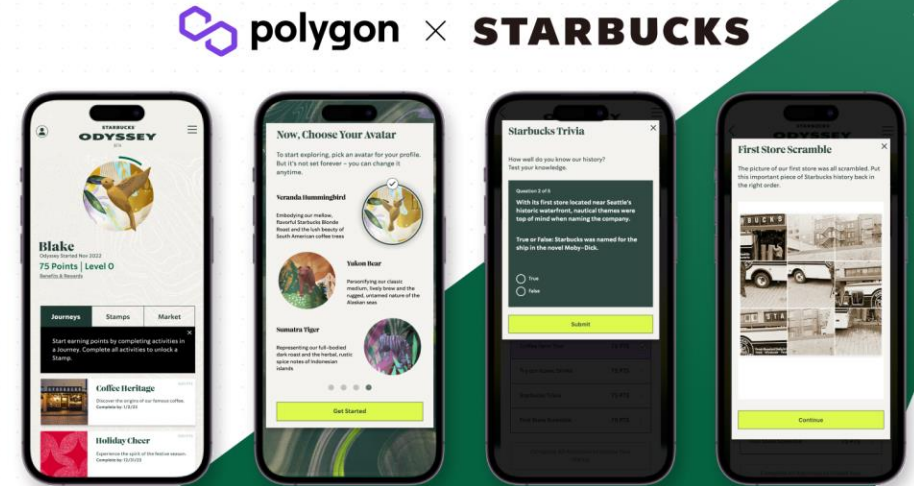
Starbucks Odyssey NFT loyalty program

Launched in: 2022

Platform:  **poly**gon

Starbucks has always been a **pioneer in the loyalty space**. Starbucks' rewards program is so successful that it has over 27 million active users.

Starbucks unveiled **Starbucks Odyssey** as an **extension of its existing rewards program** leveraging Web3 technology



“New Starbucks Odyssey experience will offer members the ability to earn and buy digital collectible stamps (NFTs) that will unlock access to new, immersive coffee experiences.”



Starbucks Odyssey NFT loyalty program

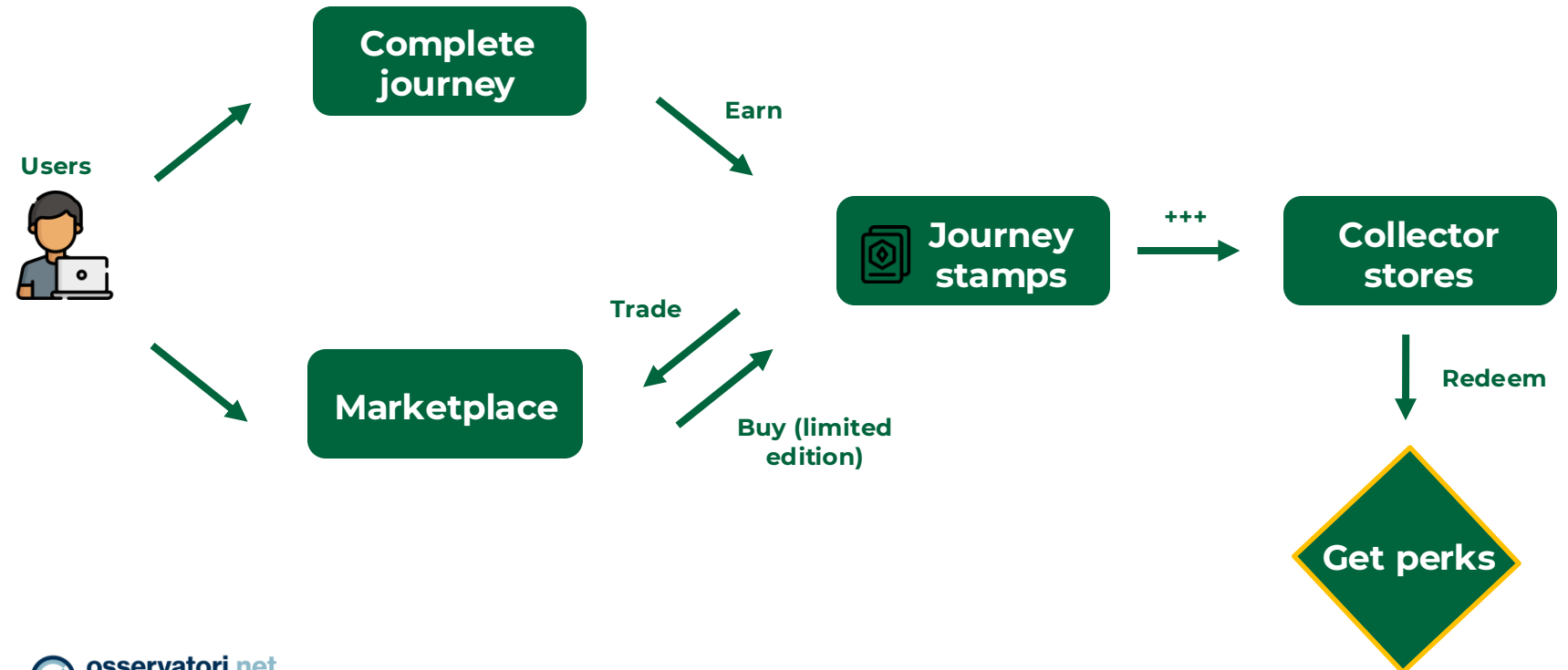
Launched in: 2022

Platform:  **polygon**

*In Starbucks Odyssey program, users could earn **digital collectible stamps** (NFTs) **associated with unique perks** by completing «journeys»*

Users can **complete a journey** and **earn an NFT** (the Journey stamps) in the following ways:

1. Spend on Starbucks goods
2. Engage with educational coffee activities
3. Play virtual interactive games





Starbucks Odyssey NFT loyalty program

Launched in: 2022

Platform:  **poly**gon

Key numbers

42,000
NFT holders

200,000+
NFT released

2.3 mln\$
secondary trading
volume

172,000 \$
revenue from
secondary market*



Starbucks leveraged **Web3** to enhance its loyalty program, **empowering users** and further **engaging with its community**



Lufthansa Uptrip NFT loyalty program

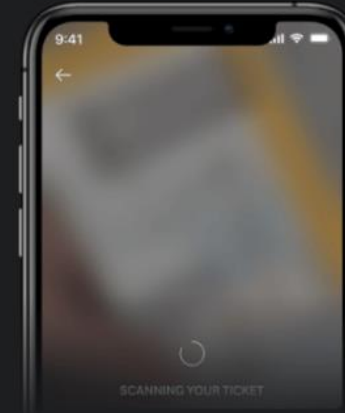
Launched: August 2023

Platform:  **polygon**

Lufthansa passengers can **scan their boarding passes** and exchange them for **NFT trading cards**.

Within the app, users must connect their **crypto wallets** to **mint** and **transfer** their **Uptrip NFTs**

Passengers that complete specific NFT collections will be **eligible for rewards**, such as flight upgrades, airport lounge access, frequent flyer status or award miles



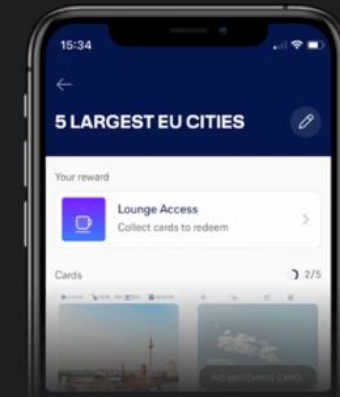
1. Scan your boarding pass

Or upload your boarding pass after your trip. It's that simple



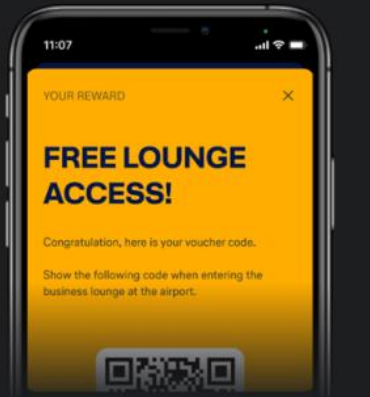
2. Choose two cards for your personal collection

You can choose the cards you need to complete a collection or just your favorite ones



3. Complete collections

We have more than 10 collections that you can complete, each one with a reward



4. Redeem your reward

When you complete a collection you get a reward - just try it out!



Lufthansa Uptrip NFT loyalty program

Customers can store the NFTs in their **own crypto wallets**.
NFT cards can be sold and **traded on popular marketplaces**.

20,000+
sign-ups

to the Uptrip loyalty program

200,000+
NFT trading cards
minted

Both Starbucks and Lufthansa **successfully integrated Web3** tools into existing loyalty programs, using tokens to further **engage, empower users**, and **boost community involvement**



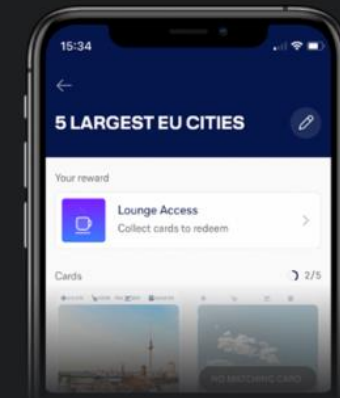
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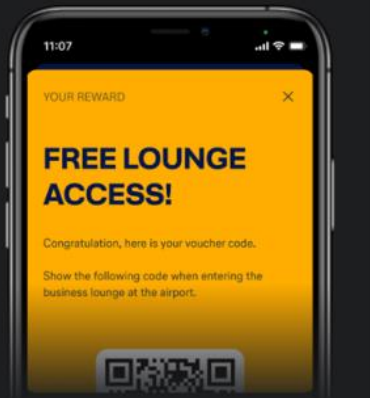
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«Lacoste NFTs project «UND3W» gives owners the opportunity to co-design»

hypebeast.com, 15/06/2022

«Nike Launches .SWOOSH, a New Digital Community and Experience»

about.nike.com, 14/11/2022



«A Guide to NBA Top Shot NFTs: Videos Are the New Trading Cards»

nftnow.com, 15/09/2024

«NFT, Telepass launches a collection of a thousand digital works within the Ethereum blockchain»

firstonline.info, 28/07/2022





What about **native players** in Web3?

Which **business strategies** are they implementing?



Axie Infinity is a blockchain-based **play-to-earn game**, where **users are directly incentivized with tokens** to play and engage in the game.

*Unlike Starbucks or Lufthansa, where tokens are tied to company perks, Axie Infinity's **tokens hold market value** outside the Axie gaming DApp*

Central role of the **community**

- **Users are empowered** through **ownership** of assets and active **participation** in the game's decision-making processes
- The **community creates value** by engaging in the tournaments and discussing strategies

Value of the tokens

- AXS and GMT tokens **have utility** within the **game ecosystem**
- Users **can also sell the tokens** on the open market for a profit



Sorare is a blockchain-based fantasy football game where **players own, collect, trade, and manage** digital player cards represented as NFTs

*Unlike Starbucks or Lufthansa, where tokens are tied to company perks, Sorare's player cards and rewards also have a **market value** beyond the game*

Central role of the *community*

- **Sorare has built a strong community** of football fans, NFT collectors, and enthusiasts
- **Users actively engage in proposing and discussing strategies** on online forums, and trading cards peer-to-peer

Value of the tokens

- **Players earn rewards** in the form of **ETH** and limited edition player cards (**NFTs**) based on their team performance in fantasy leagues
- **Cards** can be bought, sold, or traded on the **open market**



What could they do to go full Web3?



STARBUCKS
ODYSSEY



Leverage Web3's **openness**:

Integrate loyalty NFTs with those of **other traditional companies** to enlarge the value creation of the ecosystem

What if Starbucks and Lufthansa integrated their programs?

Leverage Web3's **composability**:

Stimulate external actors to **build upon** their existing **loyalty NFTs**, providing incentives, technical guidance, etc.

What if other brands leverage existing loyalty NFTs to develop tailored services? (just like Ticketmaster did with Avenged Sevenfold!)



Web3 is changing the rules of business



New relationship with
business partners



**New relationship with
users**



New relationship with
competitors

Web3 enhances community-driven models,
as user engagement is embedded in the idea of
decentralization

Web3 also provides the tools to enable it
(e.g., tokens, smart contracts, DAOs, etc.)

Strategy 2:
**Empowered
community**

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New relationship with
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Web3

Read
Write
Own



Web3 is changing the rules of business



New relationship with
business partners



New relationship with
users



New relationship with
competitors

Strategy 1:
**Permissionless
business partnership**

Strategy 2:
**Empowered
community**

*When looking at these strategies **from a broader perspective**, rather than focusing on individual use cases, **new strategic dynamics can emerge**.*

Strategy 3:
**Transparency of
the code base**

Strategy 4:
...

Strategy 5:
...

Strategy n:
...



Argent is a self-custodial wallet that simplifies DeFi by integrating and streamlining interactions with multiple DeFi protocols, without requiring formal partnerships

Strategy 3:
**Transparency of
the code base**

Argent managed to integrate external DeFi DApps **leveraging the transparency and accessibility** of their smart contracts



Web3 is changing the rules of business



Lego-like service integration



Enhanced «copy & paste»



Identity, data & asset ownership



Increased user involvement



Tokenization

Web3's **openness** and **composability** can still be **further leveraged**



New
opportunities
and
threats



Theats can be
mitigated with the
right approaches

Web2.5 initiatives in the
market have **already begun**
to leverage these features

How can incumbent leverage Web3 strategies?

Given the **distinct dynamics of market competition in Web3**, companies can also leverage these factors as innovative defensive strategies.



Your user community as a competitive advantage

In a world where every piece of code can be copy-pasted, building and nurturing a passionate user community becomes a powerful competitive advantage



Your product as a Lego block

Leveraging combinatorial innovation «from the other side» can position you to capitalize on your competitors' moves



Smart contracts as control mechanisms

Smart contracts can be designed with built-in limitations to safeguard against misuse and opportunistic behaviors



SushiSwap

vs



UNISWAP

Year: 2020

Platform:  ethereum



Uniswap is a leading decentralized exchange (DEX) launched in 2018 on Ethereum, that allows users to trade crypto-assets without intermediaries



SushiSwap

Sushiswap is a similar DEX protocol. Launched in 2020, it aimed to grow by attracting liquidity from Uniswap

Sushiswap «Vampire Attack» was a **strategic maneuver** to **incentivize liquidity providers (LPs)** to **migrate from Uniswap to SushiSwap**.





SushiSwap

vs



UNISWAP

Year: 2020

Platform:  ethereum

How a “Vampire Attack” works

A vampire attack is a strategic move in Web3 for launching a product and onboarding users by capitalizing on the existing success of a leading protocol. This process is typically divided into four main steps:



Identify the leading protocol



Target a dominant protocol with a large user base and trusted ecosystem.



Fork its code



Copy the open-source code to replicate the core functionalities of the protocol.



Add features



Introduce new functionalities or improvements to differentiate and attract users.



Create incentives



Offer rewards, such as token airdrops, to encourage user migration.



SushiSwap

vs



UNISWAP

Year: 2020

Platform:  ethereum



Identify the leading protocol



Fork its code



Add features



Create incentives

Sushiswap took advantage from the **transparency** of Uniswap's smart contracts

- Sushi was able to **rapidly develop a new product** by forking the existing codebase of Uniswap
- **Sushiswap is a fork of Uniswap V2**, these two work in exactly the same way
- One major difference is that Sushiswap has enabled **a profit-sharing mechanism** which benefits the SUSHI token holders



SushiSwap

vs



UNISWAP

Year: 2020

Platform:  ethereum



Identify the leading protocol



Fork its code



Add features



Create incentives

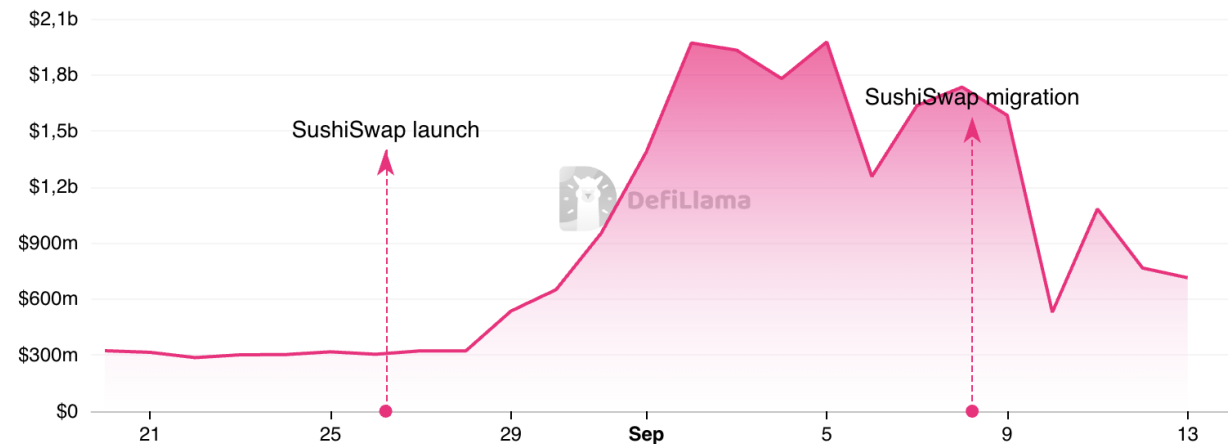
- **Uniswap's liquidity providers were incentivized to stake their LP tokens on SushiSwap**, so they could receive extra rewards paid in the SUSHI token.
- This initiative (yield farming) **boosted the liquidity on Uniswap**

USD

ETH

Uniswap TVL

<>



Source: defillama.com



SushiSwap

vs



UNISWAP

Year: 2020

Platform:  ethereum



Identify the leading protocol



Fork its code

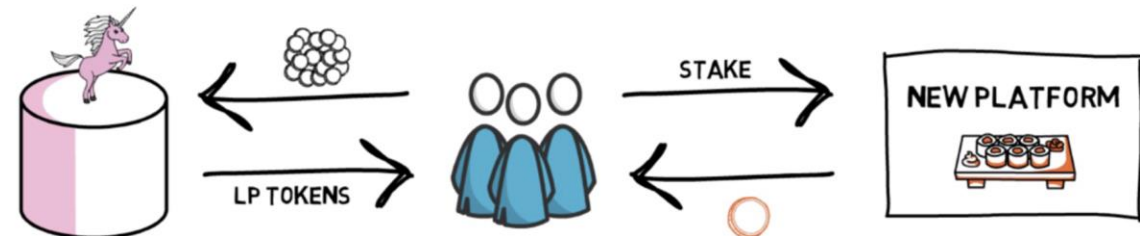


Add features



Create incentives

- **Sushiswap convinced Uniswap liquidity providers to migrate their funds**, targeting users already staking Uniswap LP tokens on SushiSwap (thus, **without need to attract new investors**).
- **SushiSwap incentivized users to switch** by offering SUSHI token rewards for depositing into its liquidity pools





SushiSwap

vs



UNISWAP

Year: 2020

Platform:  ethereum



**Bonus step:
Uniswap response**

Uniswap reacted by **leveraging its user community**, rewarding its early contributors

1 UNI token launch and airdrop

Uniswap announced the launch of UNI token

2 Uniswap's liquidity mining program

Incentivized liquidity pools with extra UNI tokens.

3 Uniswap's distribution of governance rights

As UNI token holders, participants could engage in Uniswap's governance by:

- **Proposing** changes to the protocol
- **Voting** on change proposals
- **Delegating** their voting power to a third party

USD

ETH

Uniswap TVL

Source: defillama.com

<>





SushiSwap

vs



UNISWAP

Year: 2020

Platform:  ethereum

*Closing thoughts: **are Vampire Attacks legitimate?***

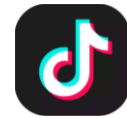
This type of **market competition** mirrors that of Web2 services, where **competitors can replicate** and develop similar features in-house.



vs



vs



Innovative Web3 business strategies highlight the need for companies to anticipate such scenarios and **develop effective countermeasures**

How can incumbent leverage Web3 strategies?

Given the **distinct dynamics of market competition in Web3**, companies can also leverage these factors as innovative defensive strategies



Your user community as a competitive advantage

Uniswap leveraged its community as a defensive strategy



Your product as a Lego block

Uniswap is built as a Lego block



Smart contracts as control mechanisms

Newcomers can also exploit smart contract-enabled limitations to defend themselves!

Welcome and introduction

Giacomo Vella, *Blockchain & Web3 Observatory*

How business partnerships work in web3

Giacomo Vella e Davide Ghezzi, *Blockchain & Web3 Observatory*

Case study: Superfluid Finance

Michele D'Aliessi, *Superfluid*

Case study: LFJ

DavideFi, *LFJ*

The role of user community

Giacomo Vella e Davide Ghezzi, *Blockchain & Web3 Observatory*

Case study: Over the Reality

Diego Di Tommaso, *Over the Reality*

Case study: Folks Finance

Filippo Moraschi, *Folks Finance*

Innovative dynamics in market competition

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Q&A and open discussion

moderated by Valeria Portale, Blockchain & Web3 Observatory

Conclusion and aperitif

Giacomo Vella, *Blockchain & Web3 Observatory*



Web3 is changing the rules of business



Lego-like service integration



Enhanced «copy & paste»



Identity, data & asset ownership



Increased user involvement



Tokenization



New relationship with
business partners



New relationship with
users



New relationship with
competitors



Web3

Read
Write
Own

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Gli Osservatori Blockchain & Web3 e Innovative Payments sono (per la seconda volta) tra i **vincitori della terza Call for Proposal di Milano Hub**, il centro di innovazione della Banca d'Italia.

Cosa analizzeremo?

L'impatto degli e-money token nell'ecosistema dei pagamenti istantanei.

Esploreremo come questi asset digitali, che uniscono la flessibilità delle criptovalute alla stabilità garantita da asset di riferimento, possano ridefinire il futuro dei pagamenti digitali.



Gli Osservatori Blockchain & Web3 e Innovative Payments si sono candidati alla **Call for expressions of interest in innovation partnerships for the digital euro** nella sezione visionary promossa dalla **Banca Centrale Europea**.

Abbiamo proposto una joint application con i seguenti use case teorici:

DvP

Escrow account

Cross-border payment

Micropayments

Transparent transfer of funds

Two disruptive case





Il Convegno finale si terrà
il **24 Gennaio 2025 alle ore 9.00**



Il Convegno finale si terrà presso **l'Aula Magna De Carli** a Milano e in **streaming sul sito Osservatori.net**



L'obiettivo è quello di illustrare le principali modalità di utilizzo delle **tecnologie blockchain**, il livello di adozione tra le aziende e le istituzioni pubbliche a livello globale, la **quantificazione del mercato italiano** per le soluzioni blockchain, il **livello di adozione degli asset digitali** tra i cittadini, i **principali trend tecnologici** e le opportunità di trasformazione del **web3 nel business**



Verranno coinvolti **aziende, esperti e istituzioni**



L'evento si terrà completamente **in italiano** e sarà **aperto al pubblico**



SUBSCRIBE





MATERIALE per l'INTERVENTO

Vi condivideremo una agenda con una **proposta per il vostro intervento:**

- **Intervento in tavola rotonda**
- **Intervento con speech frontale**

Mandare nome, job title, foto e biografia del relatore **entro il 10 dicembre**



PROFILO AZIENDALE

- ☐ **PARTNER:** mandare o aggiornare **entro il 13 dicembre**, limite di 1.900 caratteri
- ☐ **SPONSOR:** mandare o aggiornare **entro il 13 dicembre**, limite di 700 caratteri



PROMOZIONE del CONVEGNO (**PARTNER** e **SPONSOR**)

Condivideremo con voi materiale per promuovere l'evento sui social o altri canali



MATERIALE PROMOZIONALE (**PARTNER** e **SPONSOR**)

Potete cominciare a inviarci materiale che verrà condiviso all'interno degli atti a tutti gli iscritti al Convegno **entro il 20 gennaio**

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SCHOOL OF MANAGEMENT
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INFORMAZIONE E BIOINGEGNERIA



04.12.2024

Blockchain & Web3 Observatory

The Web3 playbook: New rules of the game for businesses

Workshop Web3